CHACE & RYDER

DRESSED IN THE DARK · NO. 01 · EVERYTHING HANGS ON THE TROUSERS

The Tailor *Talk Sheet*

Take this with you on your next drop-off. Most guys walk into a tailor without the words to ask for what they want, so they say "taper" and hope. This gives you the numbers to know, the exact words to use, and what no tailor can fix.

01 Know your numbers first

Measure the pair of trousers that fits you best, laid flat. Write them in before you go.

MEASUREMENT	HOW TO MEASURE IT	AIM FOR	YOURS
Front rise	Top of the waistband down to the center seam at the crotch.	Waistband at your belly button. 12" is the sweet spot for most guys.	_____
Inseam	Crotch seam straight down to the bottom of the leg.	Know it before you trust any app or salesman.	_____
Leg opening	Straight across the bottom of the leg, laid flat.	Covers about two-thirds of your shoe. 9 to 9½" for most.	_____
Waist	Across the top of the waistband, doubled.	Room for a flat hand, not a fist.	_____

02 What to say

WHEN YOU WANT	SAY THIS
The right length	*"Hem these to a slight break, so they cover about two-thirds of my shoe."*
Cuffs	*"Add cuffs, _____ inches."* (Size chart on page 2.)
A wider leg	*"Keep the leg opening at _____ inches. Please don't taper them."*
Room in the waist	*"Let the waist out so I can slide a flat hand in."*
Suspenders	*"Add suspender buttons inside the waistband. The front pair about an inch to an inch and a half from the front button."*
Belt option	*"Add belt loops sized for a one-inch belt."*

The one word to stop saying: taper. It's the first thing most guys ask for, and it's how you end up with trousers clinging to your knees every time you stand up. A balanced leg opening frames the shoe without swallowing it.

03 Cuff size by height

YOUR HEIGHT	CUFF	WHY
Under 5'5"	1¼"	A cuff stops the eye. The shorter you are, the smaller the cuff, so it doesn't break your line from top to bottom. Two inches is the standard. Cuffs also add weight at the hem, so the trousers drape better.
5'5" to 5'7"	1½" to 1¾"	
5'8" and up	2"	
Over 6'	2" to 2¼"	

04 What no tailor can fix

The rise
It's cut into the pattern. If the waistband sits at your hips, no alteration moves it up to your belly button. Check the rise before you buy, not after.

Length that isn't there
A tailor can only let a hem down if there's extra fabric folded inside. Already short with nothing to let out? It stays short.

05 What a fair price looks like

Typical ranges at a good neighborhood tailor. Big cities run higher. If a quote is far above this, ask why.

ALTERATION	FAIR RANGE
Plain hem	$15 to $30
Hem with cuffs	$25 to $45
Waist in or out	$25 to $45
Suspender buttons	$10 to $25
Belt loops added	$20 to $40

06 Before you leave the shop

- Wear the shoes you'll wear with these trousers to the fitting.
- Wear them at your natural waist when they pin the length, not low on your hips.
- Sit down once while pinned. Nothing should pull at the knees or seat.
- Read back your numbers: length, cuff size, leg opening.

Want me to go through the rest of your closet? That's the Wardrobe Edit. Ninety minutes, live, every piece gets a verdict. vladimirriche.com/wardrobe-edit